ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 85

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Nahuatl Alphabet

Ma timomachtikan nawatl!

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 19 Nahuatl Letters with English Phonetics

A a Tl tl X x

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Nahuatl Alphabet — Ma timomachtikan nawatl!
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 85

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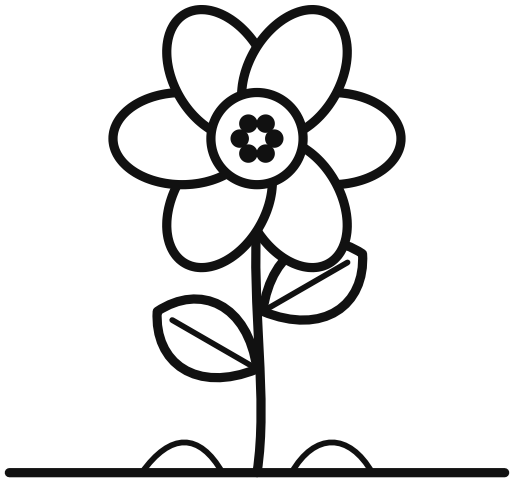
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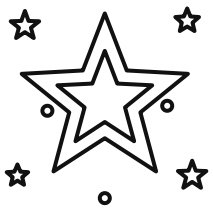
A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



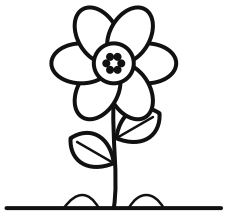
This book belongs to

Inin amoxtli itech pohui

I started learning Nahuatl on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 85 is Nahuatl. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** in the pronunciation show the stressed syllable — in Nahuatl it is nearly always the **second-to-last**: *noh-PAHL-lee*.
- **tl** in the pronunciation is one quick sound: say 't' and 'l' together, like the end of "little".
- **sh** is the Nahuatl letter **x**, and **ts** is the letter **tz**.
- **h** is the Nahuatl letter **j**: a soft breath, never a hard sound.
- Nahuatl is spoken a little differently from town to town; this book follows the central varieties.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Nahuatl name** written in Nahuatl (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Nahuatl letter name* shows a simple name for the letter (the sound plus "a": «ka», «tla»...), the way many Nahuatl primers say the alphabet.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow modern Central Nahuatl, written in the practical alphabet (k, kw, s, w, j).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Nahuatl! nawatl

NAH-wahtl — the Nahuatl word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **1.7 million people** speak Nahuatl — more than any other indigenous language of Mexico.[3]

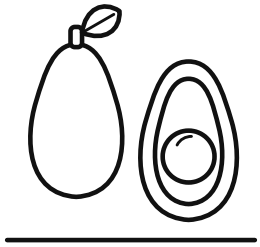
Where?
In **central Mexico**: in Puebla, Veracruz, Hidalgo, San Luis Potosí, Guerrero and around Mexico City.

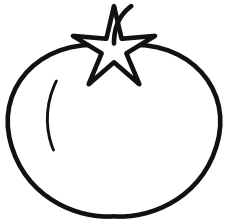
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**. Many words end in **-tl** or **-tli**.

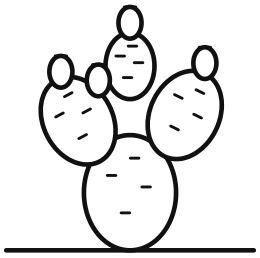
How many letters?
19 letters in the practical alphabet: 4 vowels and 15 consonants.

Words you already know!
Tomato, **avocado**, **chili** and **chocolate** all come from Nahuatl: *tomatl*, *awakatl*, *chili*, *chokolatl*.

Did you know?
The volcano **Popocatépetl**, near Mexico City, has a Nahuatl name: “Smoking Mountain”. Nahuatl also counts in **twenties**!





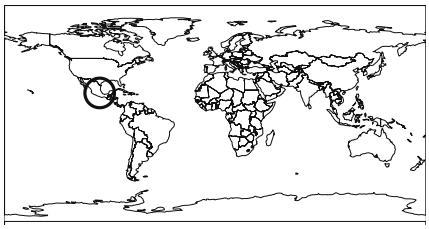


The Nahuatl Alphabet tlajkuilolli

19 letters — tlajkuilolli

Aa *ah*	**Ch ch** *chah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *hah*
Kk *kah*	**Kw kw** *kwah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*	**Nn** *nah*
Oo *oh*	**Pp** *pah*	**Ss** *sah*	**Tt** *tah*	**Tl tl** *tlah*
Tz tz *tsah*	**Ww** *wah*	**Xx** *shah*	**Yy** *yah*	

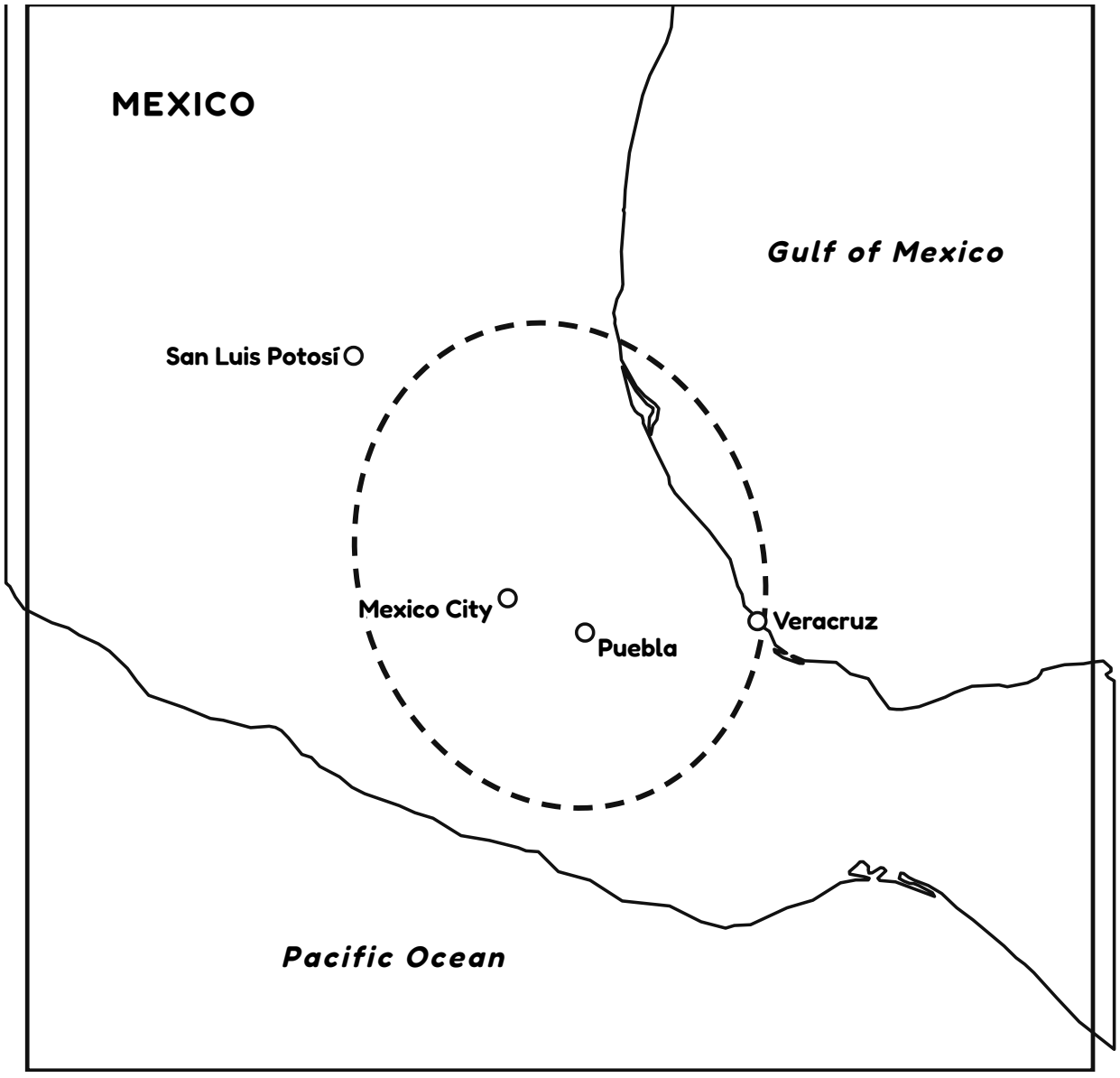
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows central Mexico on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Nahuatl spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Nahuatl is spoken in many towns and villages around Mexico City, Puebla and Veracruz and in the hills of the Huasteca. The dashed line shows where most Nahuatl speakers live.

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The Letters tlajkuilolli

tlah-kwee-LOHL-lee — “the letters, the writing”

This book uses the modern **practical alphabet** that many Nahuatl schools and writers use today: **19 letters**, four of them vowels (**a e i o**).

Letters that work as a team
Ch, **Kw**, **Tl** and **Tz** are written with two letters but say **one sound**. **Tl** is Nahuatl’s very own sound — and many words end with it: *tomatl*, *xochitl*!

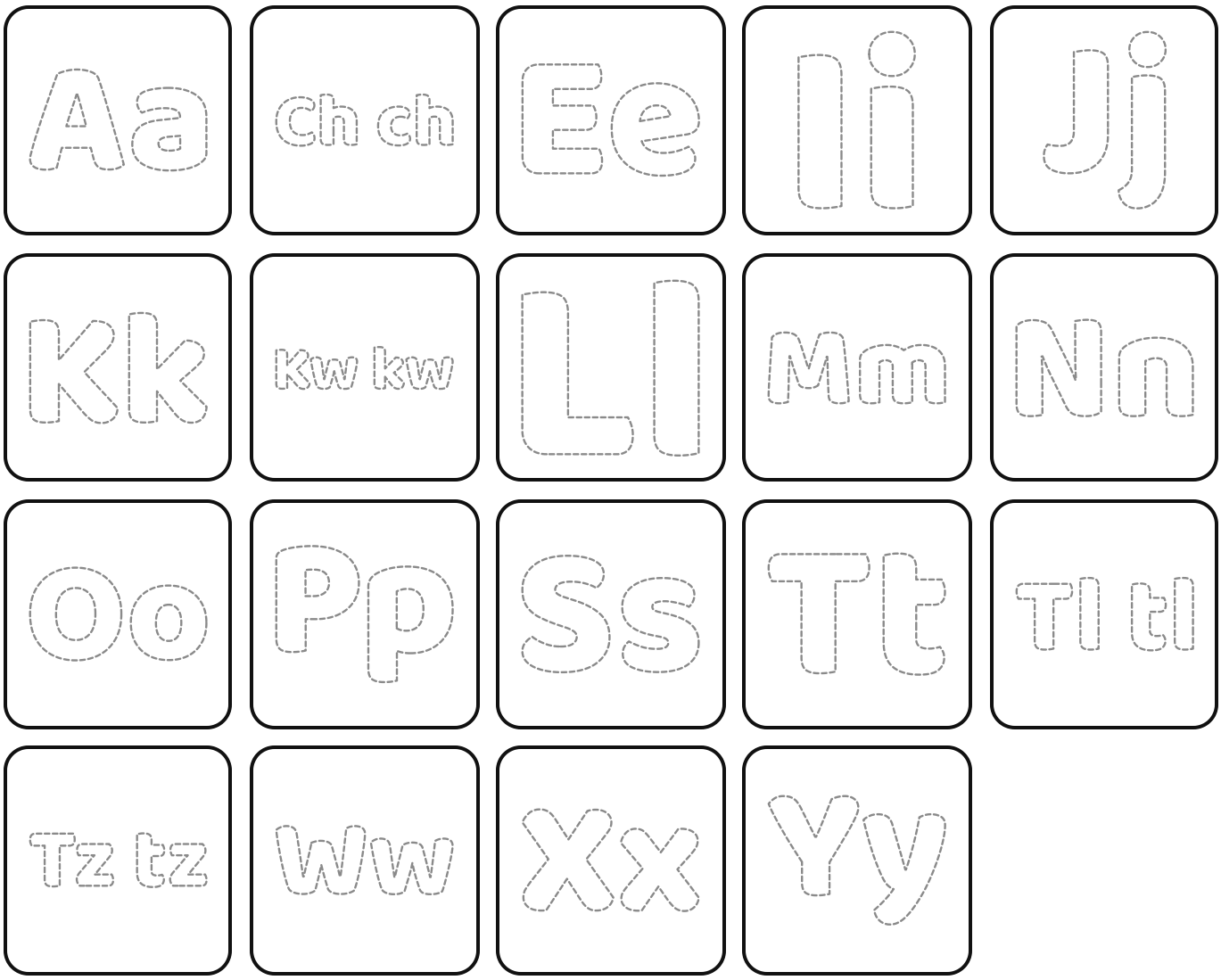
Old and new spellings
Older books use Spanish-style spellings: *c*, *qu*, *cu*, *z*, *hu*. So *calli*, *cuahuitl* and *huauhtli* are the same words as *kalli*, *kwawitl* and *wawtli*.

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**, **Tl tl**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters tlajkuilolli

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · TOKAITL

a

ah

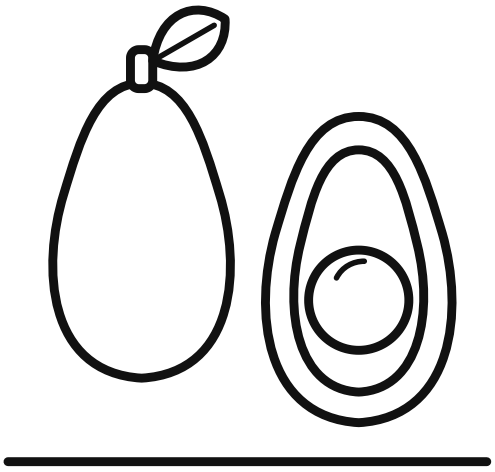
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

A a — «a»

The English word *avocado* comes from Nahuatl *awakatl*!



AA **IS FOR**

awakatl

ah-WAH-kahtl

avocado

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Ch ch

NAME · TOKAITL

cha

chah

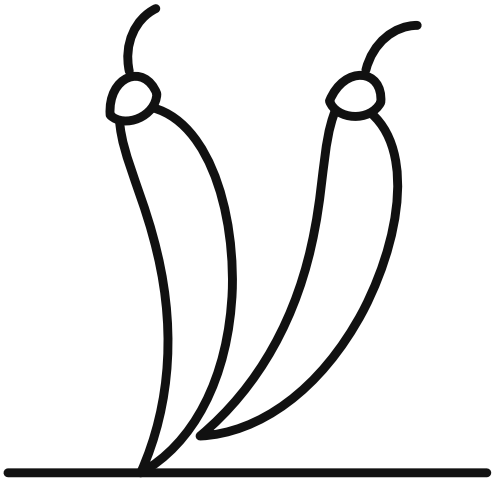
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

Ch ch — «cha»

English *chili* comes from Nahuatl *chili*.



CH CH IS FOR

chili

CHEE-lee

chili pepper

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch

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Ee

NAME · TOKAITL

e

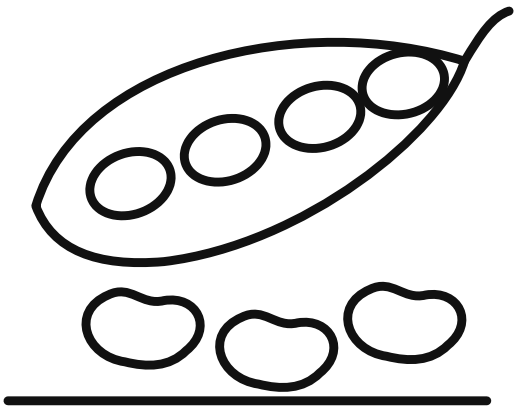
eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

E e — «e»



EE IS FOR

etl

etl

bean

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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ii

NAME · TOKAITL

i

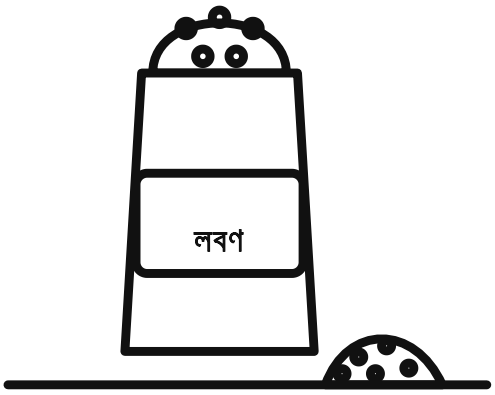
ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

| i — «i»



II IS FOR

istatl

ees-TAHTL

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

ii ii ii ii

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Jj

NAME · TOKAITL

ja

hah

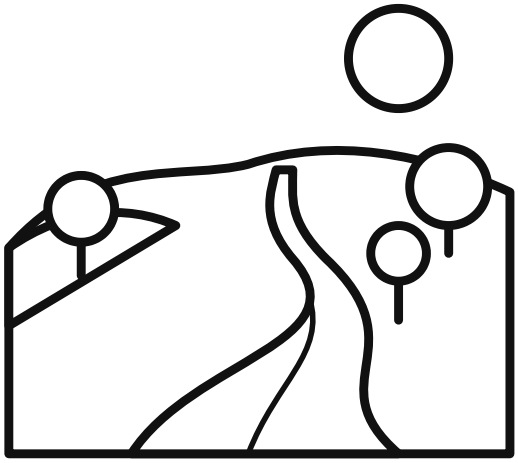
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft breath ‘h’, as in “ahead” (in some towns a little catch in the voice)

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

J j — «ja»

J hardly ever starts a Nahuatl word. Find it in the middle of *ojtli*! Older books write this sound *h*, or leave it out.



JJ IS FOR

ojtli

OH-h-tlee

road, path

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · TOKAITL

ka

kah

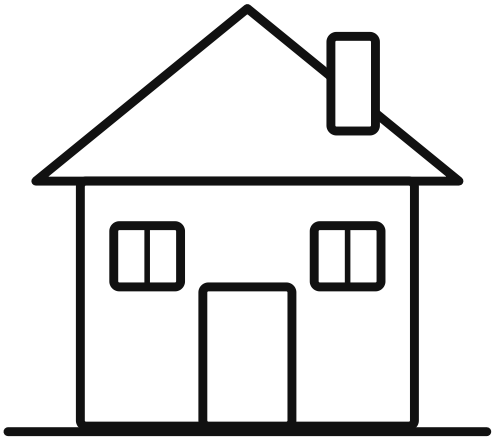
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

K k — «ka»

Older books, written in the Spanish style, spell this sound *c* or *qu*: *kalli* was written *calli*.



KK IS FOR

kalli

KAHL-lee

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Kw kw

NAME · TOKAITL

kwa

kwah

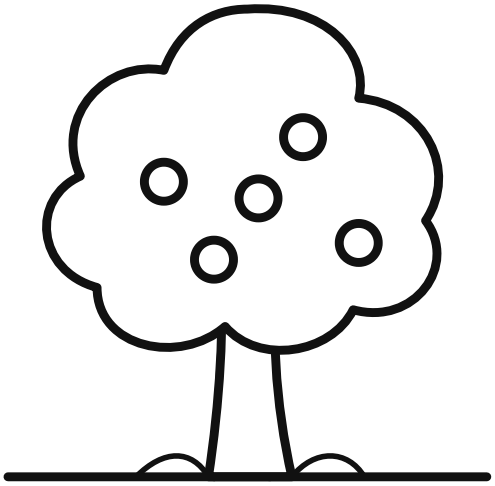
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘kw’ as in “queen” — one sound

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

Kw kw — «kwa»

Older books, written in the Spanish style, spell this sound *cu* or *uc*: *kwawitl* was written *cuahuitl*.



KW KW **IS FOR**

kwawitl

KWAH-weetl

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Kw kw Kw kw Kw kw Kw kw

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Ll

NAME · TOKAITL

la

lah

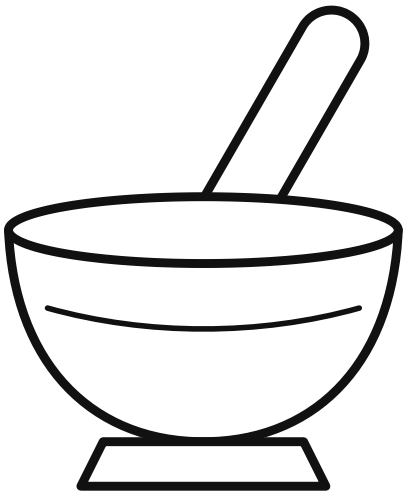
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘l’ as in “lamp”; *ll* is a longer ‘l’

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

L l — «la»

L hardly ever starts a Nahuatl word. Find it in the middle of *molkaxitl*, the bowl for grinding chili and tomato!



LL IS FOR

molkaxitl

mohl-KAH-sheetl

stone mortar bowl

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Ll Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · TOKAITL

ma

mah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

M m — «ma»



MM IS FOR

metztli

METS-tlee

moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · TOKAITL

na

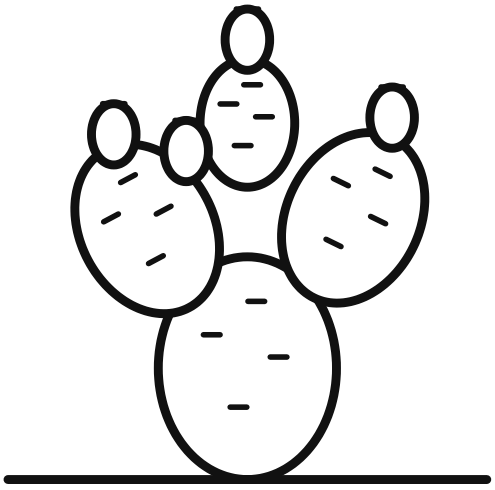
nah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

N n — «na»



NN IS FOR

nopalli

noh-PAHL-lee

prickly-pear cactus

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Oo

NAME · TOKAITL

o

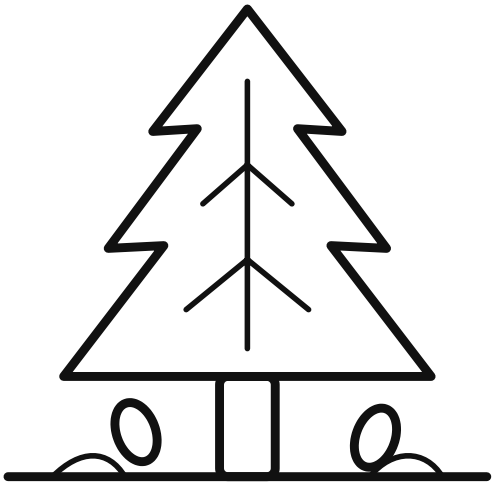
oh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “go” — some speakers say it more like ‘oo’

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

O o — «o»



OO IS FOR

okotl

OH-kohtl

pine tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · TOKAITL

pa

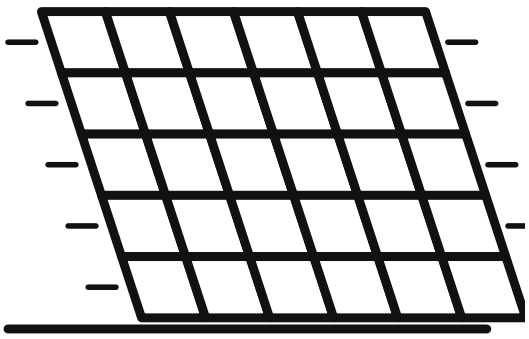
pah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

P p — «pa»



PP IS FOR

petlatl

PEH-tlahtl

woven palm mat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Ss

NAME · TOKAITL

sa

sah

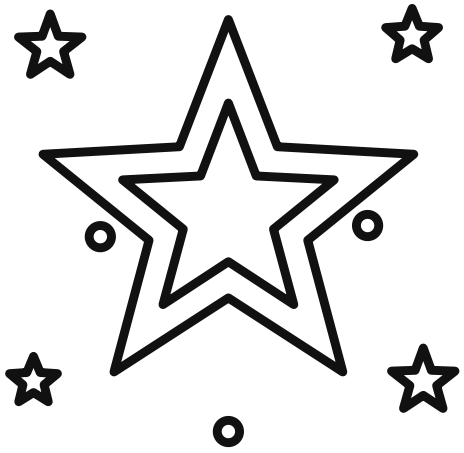
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

S s — «sa»

Older books, written in the Spanish style, spell this sound *c* or *z*: *sitlalin* was written *citlalin*.



SS IS FOR

sitlalin

see-TLAH-leen

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · TOKAITL

ta

tah

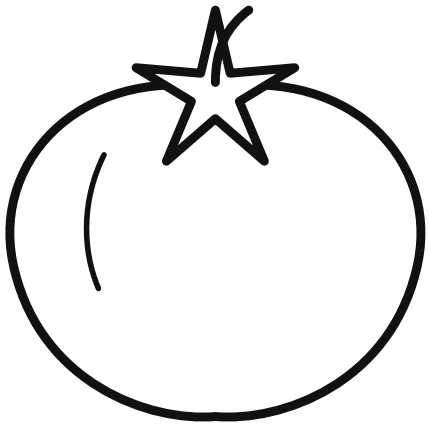
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

T t — «ta»

English *tomato* comes from Nahuatl *tomatl*!



TT IS FOR

tomatl

TOH-mahtl

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Tl tl

NAME · TOKAITL

tla

tlah

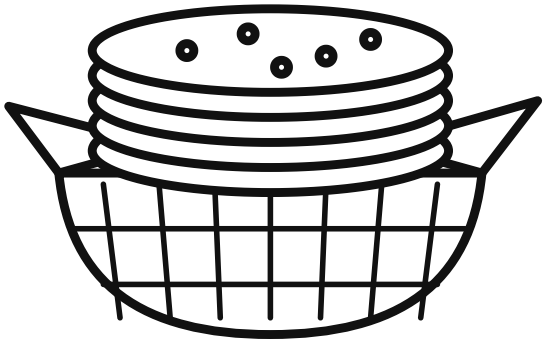
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

one quick sound: ‘t’ and ‘l’ together, as at the end of “little”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

Tl tl — «tla»

Many Nahuatl words end in **-tl**: *etl*, *tomatl*, *xochitl*.



TL TL IS FOR

tlaxkalli

tlahsh-KAHL-lee

tortillas

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Tl tl Tl tl Tl tl Tl tl

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Tz tz

NAME · TOKAITL

tza

tsah

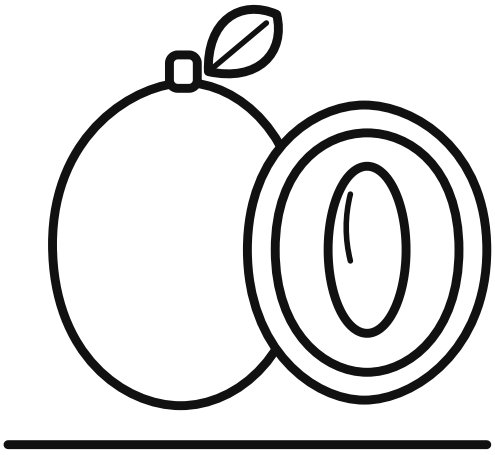
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ts’ as in “cats” — one sound

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

Tz tz — «tza»

Some writers spell this sound *ts*: *tsapotl*.



TZ TZ IS FOR

tzapotl

TSAH-pohtl

sapote fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Tz tz Tz tz Tz tz Tz tz

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Ww

NAME · TOKAITL

wa

wah

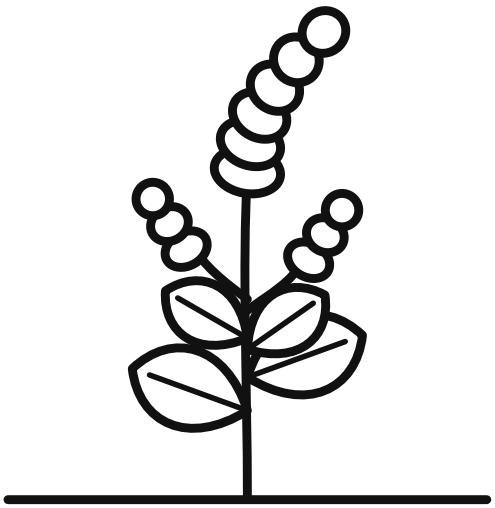
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

W w — «wa»

Older books, written in the Spanish style, spell this sound *hu* or *uh*: *wawtli* was written *huauhtli*.



WW IS FOR

wawtli

WOW-tlee

amaranth plant

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Xx

NAME · TOKAITL

xa

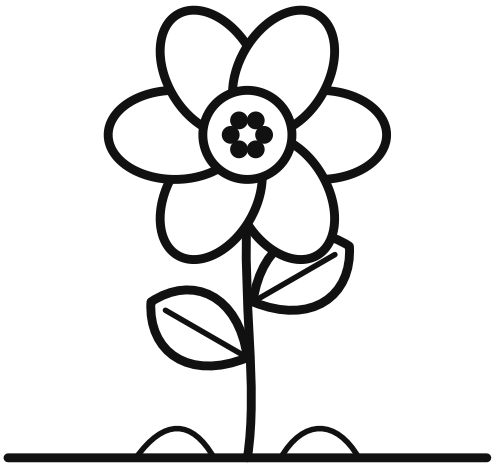
shah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “shop”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

X x — «xa»



XX IS FOR

xochitl

SHOH-cheetl

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

Xx Xx Xx Xx

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Yy

NAME · TOKAITL

ya

yah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

NAHUATL LETTER NAME

Y y — «ya»



YY IS FOR

yowalli

yoh-WAHL-lee

night

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · XIKIJKUILO

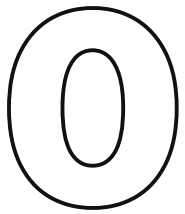
Yy Yy Yy Yy

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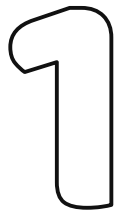
BONUS

Nahuatl numbers tlapowalli *(tlah-poh-WAHL-lee)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Nahuatl: *ah-MEE-tlah, seh, OH-meh, EH-yee...*



0
amitla
ah-MEE-tlah
zero (“nothing”)



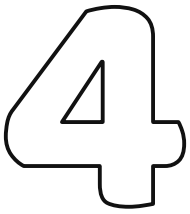
1
se
seh
one



2
ome
OH-meh
two



3
eyi
EH-yee
three



4
nawi
NAH-wee
four



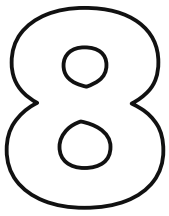
5
makwilli
mah-KWEEL-lee
five



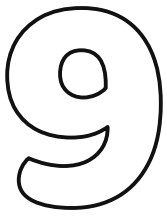
6
chikwasen
chee-KWAH-sen
six



7
chikome
chee-KOH-meh
seven



8
chikweyi
chee-KWEH-yee
eight



9
chiknawi
cheek-NAH-wee
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Nahuatl words Achtopa tlajtolli

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaikum

as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaikum assalam

wah ah-LAY-koom as-sah-LAHM
And peace be upon you (the reply)

Niltze!

NEEL-tseh
Hello!

Notokah ...

noh-TOH-kah ...
My name is ...

Tlaskamati

tlahs-kah-MAH-tee
Thank you

Jazakallahu khairan

jah-zah-KAHL-lah-hoo KHAI-rahn
May Allah reward you with good

nonan · notah

NOH-nahn · NOH-tah
My mother · My father

nokniw · noweltiw

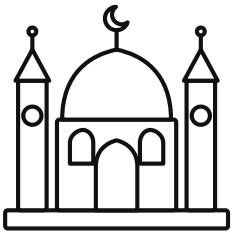
NOHK-neew · noh-WEHL-teew
My brother · My sister

kema · amo

KEH-mah · AH-moh
Yes · No

Ninomachtia nawatl!

nee-noh-mahch-TEE-ah NAH-wahtl
I am learning Nahuatl!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

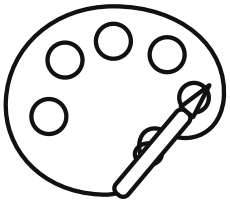
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International) and Mexico's 2020 census (**INEGI**), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **19 Nahuatl letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Nahuatl, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! Kwali otikchiw!

MAH-shah-lah! KWAH-lee oh-TEEK-cheew! — Mashallah! You did it well!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 19 letters of the Nahuatl alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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